by insects, especially those that suck blood. These include mosquitoes, fleas, and ticks. The insects become infected when they feed on infected hosts, such as birds, animals, and humans. The disease is transmitted when the insect bites a new host. Eg. Malaria, West Nile virus, and Lyme disease are all spread this way.

3. Airborne - An airborne disease is any disease that is caused by pathogens that can be transmitted through air. Some infectious agents can travel long distances and remain suspended in the air for an extended period of time. Diseases spread by droplet include tuberculosis, measles, Q fever, and Respiratory infections.

4. Fomite - borne - Fomites are inanimate articles or substances other than water or food contaminated by the infectious discharges from a patient and capable of harbouring and transferring infectious agent to a healthy person. Fomites includes soiled clothes, toys, towels, linen, cups, spoons, pencils, books, surgical dressing, etc., Diseases transmitted by fomites are typhoid, diphtheria, and skin infections.

5. Unclean hands and fingers - Hands are the most common medium by which pathogenic agents are transferred to food from the skin, nose, bowel, etc., as well as from other food.

Chain of Disease Transmission

The six factors involved in the chain of disease transmission are

11.5 Classification Of Communicable Disease

Epidemiologic classification of communicable diseases based on the mode of transmission of the infectious agent, communicable diseases can be classified as:

- **Waterborne diseases**: transmitted by ingestion of contaminated water.
- **Food borne diseases**: transmitted by the ingestion of contaminated food.
- **Airborne diseases**: transmitted through the air.
- **Vector-borne diseases**: transmitted by vectors, such as mosquitoes and flies.

Vehicle borne

An indirect transmission of an infectious agent that occurs when a vehicle (or fomite) touches a person's body or is ingested.

WATER BORNE	AIR BORNE	VECTOR BORNE
1. Tyhoid Fever	1. Chickenpox	1. Dengue
2. Cholero	2. Measles	2. Malaria
3. Hepatitis-A	3. Mumps	3. Lymphatic Filariasis
4. Acute Diarrheal Disease	4. Influenza	4. Chikungunya
5. Poliomyelitis	5. Diptheria	
6. Food Poisoning	6. Whooping cough	
	7. Meningococcal Meningitis	
	8. Acute Respiratory Infection	
	9. Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome	
	10. Tuberculosis	
	11. Swine Flu	

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